

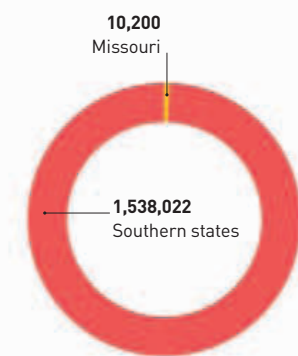
1820



Egyptian Mameluke soldiers were former slaves. By invading Sudan, Egypt hoped to add Sudanese captives to their ranks.

AS THE UNITED STATES began the settlement of western territories, the issue of **slavery** could not be ignored. Most of the northern states had abolished the practice, but the southern states had become increasingly dependent on slave labor. When the Missouri territory petitioned for statehood in 1817, it caused a political crisis over whether the federal government had the right to restrict slavery in this territory. The solution was the **Missouri Compromise**, which allowed slavery in Missouri, but not in any new state north of 36°30' latitude.

Much of Europe, meanwhile, was convulsed by political unrest, with **revolts** in the Italian states, Portugal, France, and the Low Countries. In **Spain**, Ferdinand VII had returned to the throne in 1814, rejecting the new constitution (see 1812) and arresting liberal leaders. Following public unrest, Ferdinand was forced to accept the 1812 Constitution, marking the start of the **Trienio Liberal**—three years of a liberal regime (1820–23). In 1823, France's Louis XVIII—who



Slave population

Although the slave population was small in Missouri, the question of permitting slavery in the state caused a political crisis in the US.

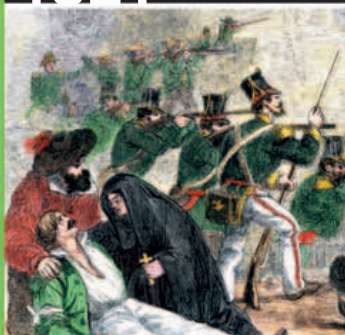
had been restored to the throne (see 1815)—sent in troops to “free” Ferdinand. These soldiers toppled the liberal regime, and returned Ferdinand to power.

Egypt invaded its southern neighbor, **Sudan**. Pasha Muhammad Ali wanted Sudanese gold and slaves for his army. By 1821, Sudan had fallen and the Egyptian Empire extended down the Nile to what is now Uganda.

“...THIS MOMENTOUS QUESTION, LIKE A FIRE BELL IN THE NIGHT, AWAKENED AND FILLED ME WITH **TERROR**.”

Thomas Jefferson, third president of the US, on the implications of the Missouri Compromise in a letter to John Holmes, April 22, 1820

1821



A woodcut illustrates the battle for independence in Mexico.

IN GREECE, A FIGHT FOR **INDEPENDENCE FROM THE TURKS** began. Resentful at years of living under oppression, people from across Greek society—including the **Orthodox Church**—began to plot their liberation. Some rebel groups had been organizing through secret patriotic societies such as the **Philikí Etaireía** (Society of Friends). These organizations involved people living on the islands, but also had significant support from the large **Greek diaspora**.

At the same time, rebels in the **Americas** were able to take advantage of Spain's internal crisis and weakness to make the final **push for independence**.

Mexico managed to secure its liberation after Mexican royalists, upon hearing the news of events in Spain (see 1820), decided that self-rule was the only way to **avoid a liberal regime** as had happened in Spain. On August 24, a treaty was signed recognizing Mexican independence, and on May 19 the former royalist Agustín de Iturbide (1783–1824) crowned himself emperor **Agustín I**.

Farther south, the **Congress of Cúcuta** was formed and formally established **Gran Colombia**, consisting of present-day Colombia, Panama, Venezuela, and Ecuador. **Simón Bolívar** was named president and Bogotá was made the capital.

In Peru, **José de San Martín** led his troops into Lima and declared **Peru independent**, though fighting to secure its freedom continued.

1822



A depiction of the coronation of Pedro I as emperor of Brazil. Pedro, the son of the king of Portugal, had declared the colony's independence.

THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN **PORTUGAL AND BRAZIL** had been fundamentally affected when the Portuguese court, fleeing Napoleon, arrived in Brazil in 1808. After **John VI** (1769–1826) returned to Portugal in 1821, he left his son, **Dom Pedro** (1798–1834), in charge of the kingdom of Brazil, as Prince Regent. Dom Pedro, frustrated by the attempt of the Portuguese Cortes to reduce Brazil to its pre-1808 colonial status, issued his **Grito de Ipiranga** (Cry of Ipiranga) declaring Brazil's independence and crowning himself Emperor Pedro I.

Even the loyalist **Santo Domingo**, on the island of Hispaniola, was swept up in the revolutionary spirit of the time, declaring **independence** in 1821, though it failed to realize a plan to join Gran Colombia. Santo Domingo's neighbor, **Haiti** (previously Saint-Domingue), grew concerned that France or Britain might sneak through the



Liberia
Located on the West Coast of Africa, alongside slaving ports, a colony for freed slaves was established by the American Colonization Society.

12 THOUSAND THE NUMBER OF FREED SLAVES RELOCATED TO LIBERIA FROM 1822 TO 1862

now poorly guarded ports in Santo Domingo and launch an attack to recolonize and **re-enslave** the island. With this pretext—and the fact that slavery still persisted in Santo Domingo—Haiti's president, **Jean-Pierre Boyer** (in office 1818–50), arrived in Santo Domingo with his forces. The provisional government turned control over to Boyer, who united both sides of the island under Haitian rule.

The issue of slavery remained contentious in the US, and there arose the additional question of how to treat **freed slaves**. The American Colonization Society, founded in 1816, advocated they be returned to Africa. The society secured agreements with local rulers in West Africa, near **Cape Mesurado**, establishing a settlement that would become known as **Liberia**.

January 29 George IV (1862–1830) takes British throne

Revolts in Spain, Portugal, Naples, Sicily, Piedmont, and Balkans (to 1823); Spain's 1812 constitution briefly restored

Northern Sudan is conquered by Egypt

Long-staple cotton introduced in Egypt, transforming agriculture and society

Missouri Compromise bans slavery north of 36°30' in the US

Greek War of Independence (to 1832)

July 28 Peru declares independence from Spain

September 28 Mexican independence recognized by Spain

Spanish rebels take Ferdinand VII prisoner; France intervenes to return him to throne the following year

Colony of Liberia established for freed slaves from the US

Haiti occupies neighboring Santo Domingo (to 1844)

September 7 Brazil declares independence in the Grito de Ipiranga

Moulay Sharif Abderrahmane (1778–1859) becomes sultan of Morocco